

with local bodies and take into account public opinion. The Government was limited to critical questions of policy and finance.

The Board now comprised a chief commissioner, who was also the ex-officio secretary to the Government of India in the Railway Department, the financial commissioner, four directors for civil engineering, mechanical engineering, traffic, and establishment, and two members, one for technical matters and the other for general administration. The financial commissioner embraced his dual role as a Railway Board member and the representative of the Government's Finance Department, which supported the capital expenses of the State railways from the public exchequer. A chief mechanical engineer was also appointed in 1922. Deputy directors and assistant directors were assigned as and when the need arose.

The Government implemented other recommendations as well, such as the establishment of the Central Advisory Council in 1922 followed by Local Advisory Councils and a Rates Advisory Committee in 1926. The enterprise was now as organized as it could be and the reforms brought about a major turn in the course of railway development in India.